Year 9 Science Test 1 Core paper

Variation and inheritance · Adaptation, extinction and natural selection · Cells and the microscope · Atoms and the periodic table

Name	Class	Date	Score / 40

Instructions · Time: 40 minutes · Total: 40 marks

- You have 40 minutes. Answer all the questions in Section A (30 marks), then try Section B (10 marks).
- Write your answers in the spaces on this paper. If you need more space, use the back of the page and write the question number.
- The marks for each part are shown in brackets, for example [2]. There are 40 marks in total.
- Read each question carefully. Use the science key words in your answers.

Section A: Core

30 marks

Answer all the questions. 30 marks.

1 Environmental variation

(5 marks)

(a) Put one tick in each row to show whether the factor is abiotic (non-living) or biotic (living). **[2]**

Factor	Abiotic	Biotic
temperature		
predation (being hunted)		
amount of light		
infectious disease		

(b) A scar is caused by a cut. Complete the sentence. **[1]**

A scar is an example of _____ variation.

(c) Put one tick in each row to show whether the variation is continuous or discontinuous. **[2]**

Characteristic	Continuous	Discontinuous
height		
blood group		
hand span		
tongue rolling (can or cannot)		

2 Inherited variation

(5 marks)

(a) Complete the sentences using words from the box. Use each word once. One word is not needed. **[4]**

nucleus	gametes	fertilisation	zygote	environment

Genetic information is stored in the _____ of a cell.

A sperm cell and an egg cell are both _____.

They join together at _____.

The new cell that is made is called a _____.

(b) Tick the two characteristics that are inherited. **[1]**

- ☐ natural eye colour
- ☐ a scar
- ☐ blood group
- ☐ being able to speak Chinese

3 Adaptation and extinction (5 marks)

(a) What is an adaptation? **[1]**

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(b) Draw one line from each way of protecting a species to how it works. **[3]**

nature reserve	endangered animals are bred in captivity to increase their numbers
breeding programme	seeds, gametes or cells are stored at a low temperature
gene bank	an area where the habitat and the species living in it are protected

(c) Grey squirrels were brought to the UK from the USA. Red squirrels are now rare in most of the UK. Give one reason why grey squirrels have replaced red squirrels. **[1]**

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4 Natural selection and evolution (5 marks)

(a) What causes inherited variation? Tick one box. **[1]**

- ☐ the food an organism eats
- ☐ genes passed on from parents
- ☐ the weather
- ☐ exercise

(b) In the 1800s, black peppered moths became more common near Manchester. The sentences below explain why, but they are in the wrong order. Write 1, 2, 3 and 4 in the boxes to put them in the correct order. **[2]**

Order	Sentence
	Birds spotted and ate more pale moths than black moths.
	A few moths had genes that made them black.
	Each generation had more black moths than the one before.
	Soot from factories made the tree trunks black.

(c) What is evolution? **[1]**

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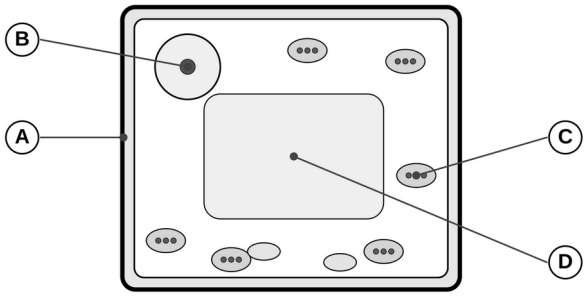
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(d) Which word means a scientific explanation that has been tested many times and is supported by a lot of evidence? Tick one box. **[1]**

- ☐ a guess
- ☐ a hypothesis
- ☐ a theory
- ☐ an observation

5 Cells and the microscope (5 marks)

(a) The diagram shows a plant cell. Write the name of each labelled part. **[4]**



A plant cell seen through a microscope (not to scale)

A _____

B _____

C _____

D _____

(b) A microscope has a x10 eyepiece lens and a x4 objective lens. Calculate the total magnification. **[1]**

Total magnification = x _____

6 Atoms and the periodic table (5 marks)

(a) Complete the table about the three particles in an atom. The first row has been done for you. **[2]**

Particle	Relative charge	Where it is found
proton	+1	in the nucleus
neutron		
electron		

(b) A sodium atom has atomic number 11 and mass number 23. **[2]**

(i) How many protons does the atom have?

protons = _____

(ii) How many neutrons does the atom have?

neutrons = _____

(c) A sodium atom has 11 electrons. Complete its electron configuration. **[1]**

2, 8, _____

Section B: Stretch and Challenge 10 marks

Try these when you have finished Section A. 10 marks. Stretch questions need a longer explanation. The Challenge question links ideas together.

7 Natural selection in the Salton Sea STRETCH (3 marks)

(a) The Salton Sea in California has become saltier and saltier since 1905. Most fish species died out, but tilapia still live there and can cope with very salty water. Explain how natural selection made the tilapia able to live in very salty water. **[3]**

8 The size of a cell STRETCH (3 marks)

(a) A microscope has a x10 eyepiece lens. A student uses the x40 objective lens and draws a cell that is 20 mm wide in the drawing. **[3]**

(i) Calculate the total magnification.

Total magnification = x _____

(ii) Calculate the actual width of the cell in millimetres. Show your working.

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9 Groups and periods CHALLENGE (4 marks)

(a) Fluorine (atomic number 9) and chlorine (atomic number 17) are both in group 7 of the periodic table and react in similar ways. **[4]**

(i) Write the electron configuration of a fluorine atom and of a chlorine atom.

fluorine _____ chlorine _____

(ii) Use your answer to explain why fluorine and chlorine react in similar ways.

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(iii) Potassium has atomic number 19. Explain why potassium is in period 4.

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END OF TEST